

3.1 Cognition and behaviour

Students will be expected to:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of psychological ideas, processes, procedures and theories in relation to the specified Paper 1 content
- apply psychological knowledge and understanding of the specified Paper 1 content in a range of contexts
- analyse and evaluate psychological ideas, information, processes and procedures in relation to the specified Paper 1 content and make judgements, draw conclusions and produce developments or refinements of psychological procedures based on their reasoning and synthesis of skills
- evaluate therapies and treatments including in terms of their appropriateness and effectiveness
- show how psychological knowledge and ideas change over time and how these inform our understanding of behaviour
- demonstrate the contribution of psychology to an understanding of individual, social and cultural diversity
- develop an understanding of the interrelationships between the core areas of psychology
- show how the studies for topics relate to the associated theory.

Knowledge and understanding of research methods (see [3.1.4 Research methods](#) (page 11)), practical research skills and mathematical skills (see [Appendix A: mathematical requirements](#) (page 25)) will be assessed across all topic areas in Paper 1. These skills should be developed by studying the specification content and through ethical, practical research activities, involving:

- designing research
- conducting research
- analysing and interpreting data.

By carrying out practical research activities, students will manage associated risks and use information and communication technology (ICT).